UHG / OPTUM · PUBLICIS SAPIENT · CATALYST PROGRAM

PM / PO
Interview-Ready Guide

Personal Narrative · Case Studies · Frameworks · SAFe
Domain Knowledge · Mock Question Bank

Built from: Catalyst 3.0 notes, SAFe training notes, QuickByte & Companion case studies, Evolution Journey deck, PO End-to-End Flow reference, and UHG health-insurance domain study
Prepared June 2026

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1 — My Product Journey & Behavioral Narrative

1.1 Career Timeline

```
May 2024                    Dec 2024                    Sep 2025                  Dec 2025
United Healthcare-UHG  -->  Optum-UHG            -->  PS Catalyst Program  -->  SAFe 6.0 PO/PM Cert
Led validation             Led QE for AI-enabled       Structured product        Completed Product
automation for web-         Health Chat assistant       mindset + strategic       Management
based claim system          (Companion) MVP->Go-Live    decision capability       Certification
```

1.2 Personal SWOT Analysis

Strengths	Weaknesses
Ownership mindset · Customer empathy · Analytical thinking · Technical skills	PPT/executive presentations · Feature prioritization · Developing stronger market-discovery skills
Opportunities	**Threats**
Align skillset to Product Management · AI-driven product innovation	Rapid technological shifts in AI · High expectations for new PMs to deliver measurable outcomes quickly

> **How to use this in an interview:** Pair every Weakness with the concrete action you're taking on it (e.g., "Feature prioritization is an area I'm actively building — I now run every backlog through RICE/MoSCoW/WSJF before committing, and I validate with stakeholders before final calls").

1.3 Impact Created (Quantified)

Highlight	Detail
Launched GenAI Healthcare Chatbot with first-time quality ownership	Defined & executed end-to-end validation across clinical journeys + edge cases
MVP in 2 months, first go-live in 3 months	Achieved with **zero** production defects
25% reduction in release & integration risk	Automated quality gates embedded in CI/CD pipelines (Azure DevOps, Jenkins)
40% reduction in manual quality effort	Automation across UI, API, Mobile, and Backend
Intent detection accuracy > 91%	Feature adaptability rate > 85% · NPS > 70

Stakeholder Testimonials (for reference/quoting in interviews)

> "Your end-to-end ownership of Companion (AI Health Assistant) demonstrated a strong product mindset — aligning multiple teams around launch priorities, proactively identifying risks, and driving timely decisions to protect customer impact." — *Senior Product Manager, UHG*
>
> "One of the best QEs on the team. Took complete ownership of delivery — driving clarity, influencing decisions, and ensuring the project landed successfully end to end." — *Director Product, UHG*

1.4 Catalyst Learnings — Shift in Mindset

Learning Investment	Measured & Capability Outcomes
70+ hrs structured learning on Product Superpowers · Live sessions with core team · 1:1 mentoring with product leaders · SAFe POPM certification · 2 product-framed project presentations with panelist · Multiple internal product case studies	Overall showcase score → 64% · Presentation & storytelling → 3/5 · Improved problem framing capability · Stronger executive presentation & storytelling · Better understanding of KPIs & product metrics · Improved roadmap awareness & prioritization

1.5 Future Roadmap as PM (Leveraging Role Change)

- Own a product module within **12 months** and scale toward influencing product strategy and roadmap decisions
- Launch at least one AI-driven product experiment using agentic workflows (e.g., Slingshot Agents) within **18 months**
- Drive feature adoption >70% within 18–24 months
- Leverage healthcare domain knowledge for cross-domain insights
- Earn advanced product certification (PSPO II) within 12 months
- Join a product community to stay updated on training & opportunities
- Mentor 2 Catalyst aspirants annually toward Product Manager roles through the PS Catalyst program

1.6 STAR Method — Behavioral Answer Structure

Letter	What to Cover
Situation	Context — what was happening, why it mattered
Task	What was your specific responsibility / what needed solving
Action	What YOU did — be specific, use "I" before "we" on the queue
Result	Quantify the outcome — numbers, %, $ wherever possible

Key behavioral framing rules (from PPT feedback notes):

- No long intro needed before getting to the point
- Don't clutter slides/answers with text — be concise
- Don't spend too much time on the first 2 points of a story
- Put your solution/result early — don't bury it
- Use storytelling, not a dry list of bullet points
- Lead with "I" — what was YOUR individual contribution before describing team outcomes

Leverage Role framing: Distinguish "Project Ownership" (you ran point on scope/timeline/risk) from "Effective Ownership across E2E responsibilities" (you influenced outcomes beyond your formal scope — e.g., quality, stakeholder alignment, business impact). Use the second framing when asked about scope beyond your title.

Reused Q&A from notes
Q: Did you have SAFe in UHG?
A: Not really, but to some extent. We don't have quarterly PI Planning across teams for identifying dependencies and planning the next 3 months. We don't have an established ART (Agile Release Train).

2 — Core PM/PO Frameworks & Vocabulary

4.1 Catalyst 3.0 Framework (UHG Internal Model)

Pillar	What It Covers
Case → Transformation Mindset & Principles	The "why" behind adopting a product mindset across UHC/Optum
Ignite → Shape → Incubate → Build → Scale	The 5-stage product lifecycle (mnemonic: **ISIbS**) — idea sourcing through full-scale rollout
Prioritization of Features	Weighted/shortest-job-first techniques (see 2.3)
Outcome Obsession (superpower)	Output vs. Outcome · Quantitative vs. Qualitative · Ask the right question · KRA = Key Result Area
Customer & Value Orientation	Customer centricity · Design thinking · Value orientation · Value proposition → "what's the bridge from product to customer?"
Data & Tech Aptitude	Tech aptitude based on data points — grounded in real datasets, not assumptions
Strategic & System Thinking	Problem → System Thinking → Solution/Outcome; "infinite" framing (continuous) vs. "finite" framing (bounded)

> **Capacity Allocation Framework (preferred guardrail model over fixed allocation):** Strategic Initiatives 35% · Customer Enhancement 20% · Tech Debt 15% · Bugs 15% · DB/Compliance Coverage 15%

4.2 Discovery Toolkit

Tool	Purpose
Empathy Map	Understand the customer's problem — what they Say / Think / Do / Feel
Persona	A representative archetype of your target user, grounded in research
Customer Journey Map	End-to-end stages a customer moves through (Discover → Onboard → Order → Track → Retain, etc.)
Use Case	A specific scenario describing how a user interacts with the system to achieve a goal

Tools to build these: Mural, Figma, Rally, Jira

Value Proposition → Value Pool → Value Stream

Term	Definition
Value Proposition	The promise to the customer — why they should use your product (answers: "why does a customer use our product?")
Value Pool	Where the money comes from — revenue sources across the ecosystem
Value Stream	The end-to-end steps (Ops → Dev) needed to deliver the value proposition to the customer

4.3 Prioritization Techniques — Full Comparison

Framework	Formula / Logic	Best Used For
MoSCoW	Must / Should / Could / Won't have	Defining MVP / release scope
RICE	(Reach × Impact × Confidence) ÷ Effort	Data-driven decisions on large initiatives; story/epic/feature-level scoring
Value vs. Effort (2×2)	Plot Value (y) vs. Effort/Time (x)	Quick Wins (high value/low effort) vs. Big Projects (high value/high effort) vs. Fill-ins
WSJF	Cost of Delay ÷ Job Size, where Cost of Delay = Business Value + Time Criticality + Risk Reduction/Opportunity Enablement	SAFe / Portfolio-level decisions; "Weighted Shortest Job First"

WSJF Worked Inputs

Feature	Business Value	Time Criticality	Risk Reduction / Opp. Enablement	Job Size	WSJF
(Example row — fill per feature)	+	+	+	÷	=

Decision context: WSJF is typically used at the portfolio/strategy level (cross-ART decisions); RICE for story/epic/feature level; MoSCoW for MVP/release scoping.

3-Question Prioritization Lens (from interview-prep notes)

1. Any critical risk / compliance / impact on revenue?
2. Highest customer + business impact / solves a major pain point?
3. Strategic enabler / addresses tech debt?

> **Validation after prioritization:** Influence outcome → prioritization discussion → refined acceptance criteria → reduced release risk

> (go/no-go trade-off) → opportunity scoring ("job to be done" thinking). Always ask: "*Why this, why now, why customer-centricity?*"

4.4 OKR & North Star

OKR = Objective + Key Results. 1 Objective → 2–5 measurable KRs. KRs measure outcomes, not outputs.

Anti-Pattern	Correct Version
"Launch Feature X by Q2" (output)	"50% of target users adopt Feature X monthly by Q2" (outcome)
"Achieve compliance" (table stakes)	Compliance lives in Definition of Done, not the OKR

North Star Metric: the single metric capturing core value delivered to the user, sitting above all KPIs (e.g., QuickByte's "Monthly Repeat Orders per Active User").

4.5 Metrics Glossary (Product & Financial)

Metric	Full Form	What It Measures
NPS	Net Promoter Score	Customer satisfaction / likelihood to recommend (short-term signal)
CSAT	Customer Satisfaction (score)	Satisfaction with a specific interaction (long-term signal)
MAU	Monthly Active Users	Unique users active in a month
ROR	Repeat Order Rate	% of users who place more than one order
AOV	Average Order Value	Average $ value per order
ANO	Average Number of Orders	Average orders per user in a period
TAM	Total Addressable Market	Entire market demand for a product category
SAM	Total Serviceable Market	Portion of TAM you can realistically serve given positioning
SOM	Serviceable Obtainable Market	Portion of SAM you can realistically capture in the near term

Release / Delivery KPIs	Customer-Facing KPIs
Commits vs. Delivered · Sprint reliability · Delivery predictability · Reads-to-Items mapped to business objective	Feature adoption rate · Reduce escalation/churn from client · App store ratings · Average load time

> **Watch-outs flagged in notes:** Don't over-rely on live-client meetings as the sole feedback source — repetitive live-client asks can bias the backlog toward squeaky-wheel requests over data-driven priority.

3 — SAFe & Agile Deep Dive

5.1 Lean vs. Agile

Agile is a **mindset** of iterative/adaptive development — optimized agile (reduced cycle time) focuses more on *how* work gets done (efficiency & optimization). Lean thinking → feeds Agile values. Includes **Gemba work** (go observe where the work happens) and mapping the **Value Stream** across Operational and Development flows.

5.2 Hierarchy: Team → Product → Solution → Portfolio

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PORTFOLIO  --  EPIC          (multiple value teams; portfolio-level)
SOLUTION   --  CAPABILITY    (more than 1 ART; large solution)
PROGRAM    --  ART           (Agile Release Train) -- delivers FEATURES
TEAM       --  TEAM          (5-12 people) -- delivers USER STORIES (US)
```

Backlog Level	Item	Owned By
Portfolio Backlog	EPIC	Portfolio Manager / Business Owner
Solution Backlog	Capability	Business Owner
ART / Program Backlog	Feature	PM (Product Manager)
Team Backlog	User Story (US)	PO (Product Owner)

Structure: EPIC → Feature → User Story

5.3 The 7 SAFe Competencies

- Leadership support
- Continuous learning
- Team & Technical Agility (PO)
- Agile Product Delivery (PM)
- (+ 3 more enterprise/portfolio-level competencies)

5.4 4 Core Values of SAFe

Value	Meaning
Alignment	Everyone working toward the same strategic priorities
Built-in Quality	Quality is everyone's responsibility, embedded throughout — not inspected in at the end
Transparency	Visible backlogs, progress, and blockers across all levels
Program Execution	Reliable, predictable delivery — mnemonic: **ABTP** (Alignment, Built-in quality, Transparency, Program execution)

5.5 PI Planning Cycle

Pre-PI	PI Event	Post-PI
Business objectives · high-level capacity · cross-ART risks & features · top priorities defined	Inspect & Adapt → System Demo → Plan for next quarter	Execution against committed PI Objectives

SAFe scaled across the large enterprise = **PI Planning + ART + Portfolio Alignment**. An **ART** (Agile Release Train) is a team of 5–12 teams (50–125 individuals), run by an **RTE** (Release Train Engineer).

> **From the "Did you have SAFe in UHG?" answer:** Not fully — no quarterly cross-team PI Planning for dependency identification + 3-month planning, and no established ART (Agile Release Train).

5.6 Feature Storming & Enabler Types

Category	Sub-types
Enabler	Spike · Infrastructure · Architectural
Stretch Goals	Compliance · (additional capacity-permitting items)

5.7 PO vs. PM vs. Client — Value Loop

```
       TEAM <----> PO/PM <---- CLIENT
                     ^            |
                     +------------+
 Feasibility -> Team
 Viability   -> PM (from ROI perspective) + Client
```

Dimension	Owner
Feasibility (can we build it?)	Team
Viability (is it worth building — ROI)?	PM + Client
Desirability (do users want it?)	PO/PM via discovery

Value Propositions diamond (Problem ↔ Solution): PO sits at the center connecting the articulated problem to the proposed solution, validating both feasibility and viability before committing the team.

5.8 SAFe Glossary Quick Reference

Term	Full Form / Meaning
PI	Program Increment — ~10-12 week planning cadence
ART	Agile Release Train
RTE	Release Train Engineer
WSJF	Weighted Shortest Job First
PCAT / PSAT	Portfolio/Program-level capability & solution backlog terms (multi-ART capability tracking)
OKR	Objective Key Results

4 — Product Owner End-to-End Flow (14 Steps)

From Requirement Discovery to Release Planning — the PO is involved in every step.

#	Stage	Goal	Key PO Activities
1	Business Problem Discovery	Understand why we're building this & expected outcome	Meet stakeholders · analyze current process · identify pain points · capture KPIs
2	Requirement Discovery Workshops	Convert vague asks into structured understanding	Conduct workshops · ask discovery questions · challenge assumptions · identify dependencies/exceptions
3	Current State Analysis (AS-IS)	Understand existing ecosystem before proposing change	Map current workflows · identify bottlenecks, duplicate steps, system gaps
4	Future State Design (TO-BE)	Design improved business process	Collaborate with architects/UX/compliance · define automation points & exception handling
5	Requirement Elaboration	Transform discussions into implementable requirements	Break into Features → Epics → User Stories → Acceptance Criteria; define business rules, validations, API expectations
6	Impact Analysis	Understand what changes across the ecosystem	Coordinate with tech/QA/ops; assess impact on APIs, DBs, UI/UX, security, downstream systems
7	Prioritization	Decide what gets built first	Prioritize by business value, regulatory urgency, customer impact, revenue, risk, delivery effort (MoSCoW/WSJF/RICE/Cost-vs-Value)
8	Backlog Refinement / Grooming	Prepare stories for development readiness	Clarify requirements · resolve ambiguities · add missing acceptance criteria · identify technical spikes (Definition of Ready)
9	Estimation & Feasibility Discussions	Understand delivery effort & technical reality	Attend estimation sessions · clarify business logic · negotiate scope · understand constraints
10	Release Scope Definition	Finalize what enters the release	Define MVP, phased rollout, release boundaries, feature toggles, deployment dependencies
11	Release Planning	Create executable delivery plan	Coordinate with Scrum/QA/DevOps/Release Mgmt; sprint allocation, UAT windows, rollback strategy
12	Stakeholder Alignment	Prevent surprises	Continuously communicate scope, risks, blockers, tradeoffs, changes
13	Pre-Release Readiness	Ensure business readiness before deployment	UAT signoff · business/operational validation · monitoring & support readiness
14	Go-Live Decision Support	Support release confidence	Final go/no-go input based on readiness checks

Where Strong POs Stand Out vs. Weak PO Traits

Strong PO	Weak PO
Understands business deeply & operations · predicts edge cases · manages stakeholders · negotiates scope · communicates clearly · balances business vs. tech · thinks in workflows, not just stories	Only writes Jira tickets · acts like a requirement courier · avoids difficult questions · depends fully on BA/Architect · can't explain end-to-end flow

Smart Questions to Ask, By Phase

During Discovery	During Design	During Release Planning
What is the actual business pain? What happens if we do nothing? What's manual today? Which team owns exceptions?	What are failure scenarios? Which systems are upstream/downstream? How are retries handled? What audit data is needed?	What are deployment dependencies? Is rollback possible? What monitoring exists? What operational team training is needed?

Important PO mistake to avoid: Blindly committing to stakeholders before engineering validation — that destroys credibility. You NEVER get all 4 of Time / Scope / Quality / Risk perfect — be explicit about the tradeoff you're making.

5 — Applied Case Study A: Companion — AI Healthcare Chatbot

What problem does it solve, and why now?

Problem (Persona: Sarah, a UnitedHealth patient user)
· Long wait times frustrate Sarah when trying to connect with a live agent · Her questions are often simple and repetitive, yet they consume valuable agent time · This leads to higher operational costs (~$57M annually) and poor user experience

Solution
Companion — an AI chatbot acting as the first point of contact: · Answers common questions instantly, with zero wait time · Offers self-service options for routine tasks · Guides Sarah to the right part of the app based on her query

> **Why Now (3 drivers):** Rising demand for digital health support · Cost optimization pressure · Advances maturing in AI

Users & How Needs Were Uncovered

Primary Users	Discovery Method
UnitedHealth consumers (patients + healthcare providers), Customer support teams	User Research · Data Analysis · Industry Trends

Core Value Proposition & Differentiation

Core Value Prop: Companion delivers instant, personalized, and accurate healthcare assistance before users reach a live agent — significantly reducing wait times, agent load, and cost-to-serve.

How It Stands Out
· Healthcare-specific intelligence (benefits, coverage, claims, billing) · Seamless warm transfer → context passed to agents, lowering AHT (Average Handle Time) · Personalized responses using member data (HIPAA-compliant) · Deep integration with UHG systems (claims, benefits, provider directory) · Continuous learning loops

Journey: Idea → Backlog → MVP, and Prioritization

Q4'25	Q1'26	Q2'26	Q3'26
Ideate & Vet: come up with project idea to resolve Sarah's issue; check on budget; approvals	Backlog Prep: decide MVP scope (SoCal, 3M users); build & test MVP features; ship/release to SoCal users	Implement other features & bug fixes; E2E test; 3 major releases to larger users; product review post-release	Bug fixes; continuous enhancement plans; plan next release scope as required

How the Backlog Was Prioritized
MoSCoW — used to identify all "must-haves" for MVP, then went for stakeholder alignment. **Stakeholder Alignment** — regular reviews with product owners and customer service teams to ensure alignment with business goals.

MVP Scope (Phase 1 — pilot SoCal patients only): Companion base UI & integration · query handling (FAQ + top N queries, intent recognition) · warm transfer to live agent/live chat.

Impact — Envisioned & Realized

Metric	Target
Interaction without escalation (post-MVP, by Feb 2026, SoCal region)	50%
CSAT	Higher, due to instant responses
Operational cost savings	$5M post-MVP · $30M by 2026

UHG / Optum Scale Context (for grounding the business case)

Metric	Value
UHG unique customers	146M (Dec 2024)
Optum unique customers	~100M

Active in social/MVP rollout cohort	~3M
Target: % of customers using LP (self-service)	~70% by 2025
Chats handled per agent per hour	~12.1
Annual operational cost (customer support)	~$57M (≈5% of total cost)

Likely follow-ups & how to answer

- "*How did you decide RAG vs. a pure LLM for Companion's backend?*" — RAG (Retrieval Augmented Generation) grounds responses in UHG's actual claims/benefits/provider data, reducing hallucination risk in a regulated healthcare context; a pure LLM alone can't be trusted with claims-specific facts.
- "*What's your ROI framework?*" — ROI after AI = lowered total cost of ownership; compare total investment vs. benefits in dollar terms (cost-to-serve reduction + escalation reduction).
- "*How do you protect PHI in an AI chatbot?*" — Personalization uses member data only within a HIPAA-compliant data boundary; no PHI surfaces in logs/notifications outside authenticated, access-controlled sessions.

6 — Applied Case Study B: QuickByte — Food Delivery Platform

Building a Sustainable, Community-Driven Food Delivery Platform for Urban UK — Strategic Product Roadmap

Company Snapshot

Snapshot: QuickByte is a London-based foodtech startup, pre-launch, with pilot operations in selected London boroughs.
Mission: Deliver fresh, diverse, and affordable meals within 30 minutes while empowering local food businesses through ethical technology and fair partnerships.
Vision: UK's most trusted community-driven food delivery platform — focusing on speed, sustainability, and empowering local culinary talent through ethical practices.
Pillars: Tech-first logistics · Local-first sourcing · Sustainability by design

Market Opportunity

Metric	Value
UK Food Delivery Market (TAM)	£17B (projected 2026)
SAM — Urban Ethical Food Delivery	£5B – £7B
SOM — Phase 1 (London Expansion)	~£10M annual revenue, ~2% of UK market by 2026 (~£340M GMV)
Current estimated market share (2025)	0.5%
Revenue Levers	Commission rates · Delivery fees · Subscription plans

Digital Footprint & Current Stats

Metric	Value
App downloads	25,000
Active Monthly Users (MAU)	8,000
Checkout conversion rate	48%
Repeat order rate (within 3 months)	30%
Average load time	5.2 seconds
iOS App Store rating	4.1/5
Restaurants onboarded / Active riders	500 / 150
Average delivery time	45 minutes

North Star Framework

```
NORTH STAR METRIC: Monthly Repeat Orders per Active User
            |
   +--------+--------+
   |        |        |
 Demand  Experience  Supply
 -New     -Avg        -Active
  users    delivery    restaurants
 -Repeat   time        -Active
  users   -ETA          riders
           accuracy

Driving Sustainable Growth -> through Repeat Behavior
```

Problem Statement — Customer & Market Challenges

Urban Food Delivery in the UK is Fragmented — Impacting Trust, Affordability & Convenience

Limited Choice & Discovery	High Delivery Cost	Unreliable Delivery	Poor App Experience
60%+ struggle to find diverse options · low visibility for local restaurants · no personalization → **Low Order Conversion**	35–40% of orders affected by high fees · hidden checkout charges · fewer repeat orders → **Low Affordability**	Avg delivery time 40–45 min · delayed orders · no real-time tracking → **Poor Customer Trust**	20% app crashes/glitches · complicated UI/checkout · low support → **High Drop-offs**

Business Impact: High cart abandonment · low retention & loyalty · negative reviews & churn

Persona: Arav Sharma — "The Modern Foodie"

Profile	Pain Points
25 yrs, marketing professional in London. Values fast, reliable, and ethical food delivery.	Discovery Friction (5–7 min browsing, no personalization) · Checkout Sensitivity (abandons on unexpected price increase) · Reliability Anxiety (avoids peak hours) · App Glitches (exits after payment friction)

Empathy Map — Arav

Says	Thinks
"Where is my food?" · "I want more local food options" · "How can I trust the food quality and ratings?"	"I hope my order arrives hot and fresh" · "I wish I could find new restaurants easily" · "Is the delivery person reliable and safe?"
Does	**Feels**
Browses & compares food options · tracks order status constantly · reads reviews before ordering	Frustrated by late/inaccurate deliveries · excited by finding new food choices · worried about hygiene

Customer Journey — 5 Stages

Stage	Customer Expectation	Challenge	Business Opportunity
Discover	Clear value proposition	Low brand awareness	Targeted awareness campaigns
Onboard	Simple onboarding	Sign-up drop-offs	Targeted awareness campaigns
Order	Accurate menus available	Streamlined sign-up process	Personalized item recommendations
Track	Real-time tracking	Delivery status uncertainty	Timely notifications & updates
Retain	Consistent quality	Consistent churn	Personalized retention offers

Strategic Alternatives Evaluation

Criteria	Discount Model	Speed Model	Trust & Sustainability (Chosen)
Margin Impact	Low	Medium	High
Differentiation	Weak	Moderate	Strong
Long-term Retention	Low	Medium	High
Brand Positioning	Commodity	Fast	Premium-Trust
Total Score	11	15	**22**

> **Conclusion:** QuickByte will compete on Trust & Sustainability, not discount wars.

Key Assumptions & Risk Mitigations

Assumption	How Validated
Users value trust > discounts	A/B test vs. discount; target repeat rate >40%
Vendors seek predictable demand	Target 3-month vendor retention >80%
Riders prefer stable earnings	Target churn <15% & shift fill rate >70%

Risk	Mitigation	Success Metric
High CAC (Customer Acquisition Cost)	Hyperlocal GTM + Referral	CAC < £20
Vendor / Rider Churn	Guaranteed earnings + Incentives	Churn < 15%
Fast Scaling	Phased rollout	On-time delivery > 85%

Platform Architecture — 3-Sided Marketplace

Customer App	Rider App	Vendor App
Discovery · Personalization · Trust badges · Live tracking	Order assignment · Earnings tracking · Route optimization · Safety support	Order management · Demand analytics · Performance dashboard

MVP (0–3 months): Primary focus = Customer App optimization; Rider & Vendor Apps leverage existing pilot apps.
Post 3 months: Enhance rider retention tools · upgrade vendor analytics · strengthen operational efficiency.

Proposed Roadmap — MVP and Beyond (Now / Next / Later)

	NOW (0-3 mo) — Foundations & MVP	NEXT (3-9 mo) — Intelligence & Optimization	LATER (9-18 mo) — Scale & Platform Leadership
EPIC 1 Food Discovery & Personalization	Personalized feed · Dietary search filters · Trending options · Visual menus	Personalized home feed · Smart recommendations · Search optimization	AI-driven personalization · Context-aware discovery · Predictive ordering
EPIC 2 Reliable &	Accurate ETA & route optimization · Live tracking · Proactive alerts · Customer support	Dynamic ETA prediction · Smart routing & batching · Delay notifications	Autonomous deliveries · Demand forecasting · SLA guarantees · Green logistics

Predictable Delivery			
EPIC 3 Trust & Sustainability	Hygiene ratings · Ingredient sourcing · Badges (trust/minority-owned)	Quality signals & prep time · Carbon footprint indicators	Eco-friendly origins · Supply chain transparency · ESG reporting
EPIC 4 Riders & Vendors	(Leverage existing pilot features)	Menu management · Earnings & pricing tools	Vendor performance insights · Dynamic incentives
Outcome	Stable Delivery / Clear Discovery	Higher Retention / Optimized Delivery / Deeper Trust	Intelligent Platform / Sustainability Edge / Market Leader

EPIC-1 Detail — Food Discovery & Personalization

Description: Enable customers to easily discover relevant food options through personalization, smart categorization, and contextual recommendations.
Purpose: Improve food discovery efficiency · increase engagement & order conversion · create a personalized, delightful browsing experience.

Feature	Description	Key Outcomes
Personalized Feed	Custom recommendations based on preferences	↑ Order conversion, ↓ time to first item added to cart
Dietary Filters	Easy selection for dietary preferences	↑ Retention (diet-specific users), ↓ search/decision time
Trending Options	Discover popular dishes nearby	↑ AOV, ↑ discovery of high-conversion dishes
Visual Menus	Engaging images of food options	↑ Add-to-cart conversion, ↑ menu engagement

EPIC-2 Detail — Reliable & Predictable Delivery

Description: Ensure customers receive orders reliably, on time, with real-time visibility throughout delivery.
Purpose: Build trust through predictability · reduce delivery complaints · improve operational efficiency.

Feature	Description	Key Outcomes
Accurate ETA & Route Optimization	Precise delivery time predictions	↑ On-time delivery rate, ↓ delivery-related complaints
Live Tracking	Real-time order status updates	↑ Customer trust & transparency, ↓ "where's my order" support contacts
Proactive Alerts	Notifications for delivery delays	↓ delay-related complaints, ↑ satisfaction during delays
Customer Support	Accessible help for delivery inquiries	↓ issue resolution time, ↑ CSAT

EPIC-3 Detail — Trust, Transparency & Sustainability

Description: Build long-term customer trust by promoting transparency in sourcing, hygiene, eco-friendly practices, and ethical operations.
Purpose: Strengthen brand trust · promote responsible consumption · align with sustainability goals.

Feature	Description	Key Outcomes
Hygiene Ratings	Ensures food safety & quality	↑ Customer trust score, ↓ trust-related complaints
Ingredient Sourcing	Highlights sustainability/ethical sourcing	↑ Brand trust & credibility
Eco-Friendly Packaging	Promotes environmental responsibility	↑ Environment-driven order conversion
Trust/Minority-Owned Badges	Visual indicators of quality & social responsibility	↑ Customer retention & loyalty, ↑ platform differentiation

GTM Strategy

Target Boroughs	Vendor Onboarding	Rider Acquisition	Community Partnerships
Camden, Hackney, Islington, East London — hyperlocal pilot launch in high-population foodie hubs	Priority to ethically-sourced local eateries · zero-commission first month · tailored low-fee model for pilot partners	Guaranteed fair earnings (not per-order) · safety & sustainability training · referral bonuses	Micro-influencers & local food bloggers · school/borough event sponsorship · co-marketing with ethical brands

Phase 1: 0–3 Months	3+ Months — Scale Up
+100 new restaurants onboarded · +50 active riders · +5,000 app downloads	Optimize CAC · launch referral & loyalty · expand to 2 more boroughs · 600+ restaurants · 200 active riders · 30,000 app downloads · >10% share in key boroughs

Product-Market Fit Validation

Target Segment	Core Hypothesis
Urban professionals (25–40) in selected London boroughs; value reliability, transparency & sustainability	If we deliver reliable ETA + transparent hygiene/sourcing + ethical positioning, then users will prefer trust over discounts

PMF Signal	How Measured	Target
Repeat Rate	30-day retention	>40%
NPS	Post-delivery survey	>50
Vendor Retention	3-month retention	>80%

Rider Churn	Monthly churn	<15%

Key Metrics (KPI) Overview — 2026 Target State

Market Share	Value
UK market projected size (2026)	£17B
Estimated market share target	2%
Restaurants / Active riders	600 / 200
Green restaurants / Green riders	60% / 80%
CO_2 emissions reduction	-20%

Digital Stats Target	Value
App downloads / Active monthly users	30,000 / 10,000
Checkout conversion rate	60%
Repeat order rate (within 3 months)	40%
Avg orders per active user per week	3
Average time to order / load time	2 min / 3.5 sec
iOS App Store rating target	4.5★

Likely follow-ups

- "*Why Trust & Sustainability over a discount war?*" — Scored highest (22 vs 11/15) on margin impact, differentiation, long-term retention, and brand positioning; discounting is a race to zero margin with weak differentiation.
- "*How did you size the market?*" — TAM (£17B, total UK food delivery) → SAM (£5–7B, urban ethical segment) → SOM (~£10M, Phase 1 London expansion target by 2026).
- "*What's your single most important roadmap decision?*" — Sequencing EPIC-2 (Reliable Delivery) before scaling EPIC-1 personalization at full depth — trust/reliability is the PMF-validating hypothesis, so it can't wait.

7 — Health Insurance & UHG Domain Knowledge (Condensed)

7.1 Plan Types

Type	Referral Needed?	OON Coverage?
HMO	Yes — PCP required	No (emergencies only)
PPO	No	Yes, at higher cost
EPO	No	No (emergencies only)
HDHP	Varies	Varies — pairs with HSA
POS	Yes, for specialists	Yes, at higher cost

7.2 Benefits Architecture

```
Member gets a service -> Preventive? -YES-> $0 cost
   | NO
Deductible met? -NO-> Member pays 100%
   | YES
Copay or Coinsurance applies
   |
OOP Max hit? -YES-> Insurance pays 100% rest of year
```

7.3 Key Regulations

Regulation	What It Mandates
ACA — Essential Health Benefits	10 required coverage categories
ACA — MLR (80/20 Rule)	≥80% of premium must go to medical care
HIPAA	Protects PHI — Privacy Rule, Security Rule, Breach Notification Rule (60-day window)
No Surprises Act (2022)	Protects against unexpected OON bills; mandates Good Faith Estimates
ERISA	Governs employer self-funded (ASO) plans

> **HIPAA in 1 line:** If you can identify WHO the patient is from the data, it's PHI. Push notifications never carry diagnosis info; every PHI-touching story needs RBAC + audit logging in its acceptance criteria.

7.4 Market Segments

Segment	Note
Individual & Family (IFP)	ACA Marketplace or off-exchange
Small / Large Group	Employer-sponsored, often via brokers
Medicare Advantage (MA)	UHC is #1 MA insurer (~7-8M members); AARP-branded plans
Medicaid / CHIP	UnitedHealthcare Community Plan, 30+ states
Dual Eligibles	Medicare + Medicaid via D-SNP plans

7.5 UHG Corporate Structure

Business	What It Does
UnitedHealthcare (UHC)	Insurance plans — Commercial (E&I), Medicare Advantage, Medicaid
Optum Health	Care delivery — 90,000+ employed/affiliated physicians, care management
Optum Rx	Pharmacy Benefit Manager (PBM)
Optum Insight	Data, analytics, Change Healthcare clearinghouse
Optum Financial	HSA/FSA/HRA administration (Optum Bank)

7.6 UHG vs. Optum — Scale Snapshot (FY2024)

Metric	Value
UHG total revenue	$400.3B (+8% YoY)
UnitedHealthcare revenue	$298.2B (74% of total)
Optum total revenue	$253B (63%* — growing ~2x faster than UHC)
UHG unique individuals served	146 million

Optum Rx consumers served	62M+ (1.6B+ scripts/year)
Optum Health patients touched	103 million

7.7 PMPM & Star Ratings — Quick Reference

Concept	Why It Matters
PMPM (Per Member Per Month)	The universal unit for pitching value: "this reduces PMPM by $8"
CMS Star Ratings (1-5)	5 Stars = +5% CMS bonus; moving 3.5→4 stars at UHC scale ≈ $2.9B additional annual revenue
Value-Based Care (VBC)	Provider paid for outcomes, not volume — success metric shifts to hospitalizations prevented, care gaps closed

8 — Master Mock Interview Question Bank

#	Question	Approach
1	Walk me through how you'd take a problem from discovery to production.	Use the 14-step PO E2E flow (Section 4) — discovery → AS-IS/TO-BE → elaboration → prioritization → backlog refinement → release planning → go-live
2	You have 10 backlog items and capacity for 3. How do you decide?	Apply RICE or WSJF; check critical risk/compliance first, then highest customer+business impact, then strategic enablers
3	What have you learnt in the past 4 months that makes you confident you're ready to be a PM?	Reference Catalyst Learnings (Section 1.4) — 70+ hrs structured learning, 2 product case studies, measurable capability outcomes
4	One thing that makes you effective as a PM, and one thing that could derail you in 6 months? (Strengths/Weaknesses)	Use SWOT (Section 1.2) — pair each weakness with the concrete mitigating action
5	Why do you think you're ready for a craft change?	Tie to Journey in PS timeline + Impact Created metrics (Section 1.1, 1.3)
6	That was the impact of your entire team — what was YOUR individual impact?	Lead with "I" — cite your specific ownership area (e.g., end-to-end validation ownership) distinct from team-level wins
7	What would you do differently when you become a PM?	Name a specific gap (e.g., feature prioritization, market discovery) and the concrete habit you're building now
8	What's the hardest part of being a PM you haven't experienced yet — and how are you preparing?	Name something genuinely unexperienced (e.g., owning a full P&L tradeoff conversation) + your preparation action
9	A VP hands you a feature request directly; your backlog data says it's low priority. What do you do?	Don't blindly commit — validate with data, present the tradeoff transparently (Time/Scope/Quality/Risk), let leadership make an informed call
10	Tell me about a product/feature that failed. What broke, and what was your role?	Use STAR; be honest about the root cause and your specific contribution to the failure and the fix
11	3 weeks from deadline, engineering says scope must be cut 40%. How do you handle it?	Re-run MoSCoW on remaining scope; protect the "Must Haves" tied to the core hypothesis; communicate tradeoff to stakeholders early
12	Given ownership of a product area tomorrow — first thing you'd do in week one, and what you wouldn't do?	Week one: discovery + stakeholder map + AS-IS analysis. Wouldn't: commit to a roadmap before validating assumptions
13	How do you define success for a feature before it ships?	Define the outcome-level KR before build (e.g., "X% adoption" or "Y% PDC improvement"), not just "feature shipped"
14	Difference between a problem worth solving and one that just feels urgent?	Worth solving = data-backed, ties to North Star/strategic outcome; urgent = loud but may be low Reach/Impact on RICE
15	As an engineer, someone told you what to build. As a PM, nobody will. How do you create your own direction?	Discovery + data + customer empathy + strategic alignment (System Thinking: Problem → System → Solution)
16	Your engineering background means you'll know more about tech than stakeholders. When is that an advantage vs. a problem?	Advantage: scoping realism, spotting weak estimates. Problem: if it leads to dictating solutions instead of validating problems/outcomes
17	You're the PM with no direct reports. How do you lead?	Influence without authority — alignment, data, stakeholder trust, transparent tradeoffs (the SAFe "Alignment" + "Transparency" values)
18	Take a product you used in the last 24 hours. What's the one thing it should stop doing?	Pick something specific and defensible; tie the "stop doing" to a clear user friction point, not a personal preference
19	Suggest 3 improvements to Microsoft Teams. Walk through your thinking for each.	Use JTBD framing for each: situation → friction → improvement → expected outcome metric
20	Google Maps — (open-ended product teardown)	Pick a persona + JTBD, identify one friction point, propose a feature, define a success metric (this is a generic "product sense" prompt — structure your own example using the Empathy Map → Persona → JTBD flow)

9 — Final Prep Checklist

☐ Rehearse the SWOT + Journey timeline out loud (Section 1) until it flows as a 90-second narrative

☐ Have the Companion case study numbers memorized: \$57M cost, 50% no-escalation target, \$5M/\$30M savings, 91% intent accuracy

☐ Have the QuickByte numbers memorized: £17B TAM, £5-7B SAM, ~£10M SOM, 22 vs 11/15 strategic score

☐ Be able to draw the EPIC → Feature → User Story hierarchy and the Team→Product→Solution→Portfolio chain from memory

☐ Be able to explain WSJF, RICE, and MoSCoW out loud with a worked example each

☐ Practice all 20 mock questions out loud — record yourself for at least Q4, Q9, Q11, Q17 (the hardest behavioral/judgment ones)

☐ Know the HIPAA 3 rules and the PO 14-step E2E flow well enough to sketch from memory

☐ Prepare 2-3 questions to ask the interviewer about UHG's product organization structure

— End of Guide — Consolidated from Catalyst 3.0 notes, SAFe training notes, QuickByte & Companion case studies, Evolution Journey deck, and PO End-to-End Flow reference —